

The 2026 Watermelon Internal Quality Benchmark

What could reducing watermelon
shipment rejections from 3.5% to
1% be worth?

A field-based reference for U.S. watermelon
growers, packers, and shippers.



Most of the fruit remains unseen inside.

At the packing line, destructive sampling and the know-how of a few experienced tappers are the only line of defense.

3.5%

PRACTICAL FIELD REFERENCE

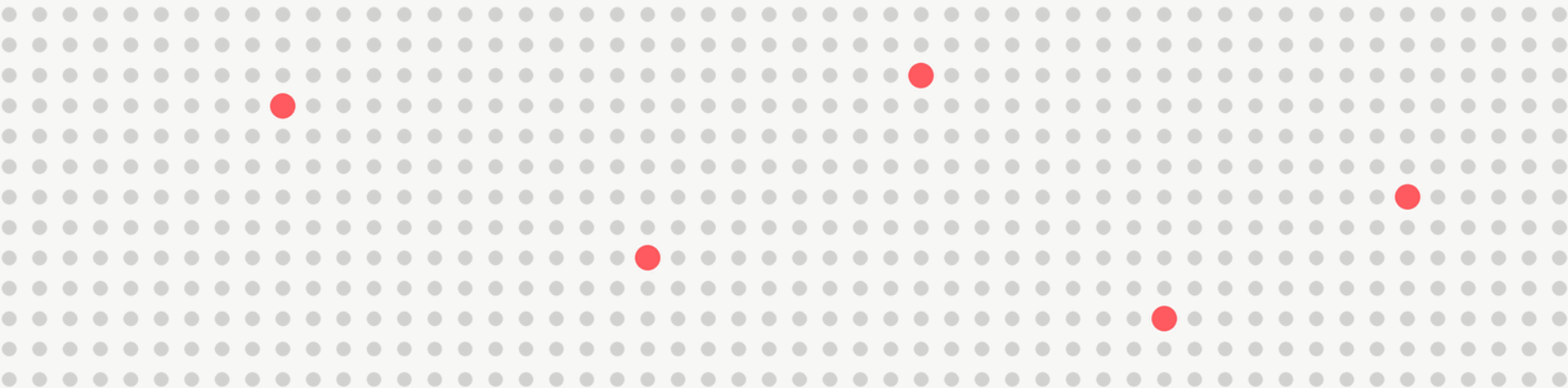
1%

TARGETED REJECTION RATE

\$700K

UP TO – MODELED ANNUAL SAVINGS, 60M LB OPERATION

The 3.5% figure is a practical field reference, **not a statistically representative national average**. Strong producers may already perform materially better — and should be able to demonstrate it.



What the reduction is worth.

Representative 60-million-pound seasonal operation, moving from a 3.5% rejection rate to a 1% target. **Upper-bound scenario, full capture.**

Freight and rerouting avoided	\$281,250
Product value recovered	\$330,000
QC labor savings or redeployment	\$38,961
Claims and chargebacks avoided	\$50,000
Total modeled annual savings	\$700,211

\$700,000

UP TO – MODELED ANNUAL SAVINGS

An upper-bound scenario using full capture. A decision-making reference, not a guaranteed result. Actual savings require operation-specific validation.

Excludes destructive-sampling savings, premium pricing, and incremental revenue. Not independently validated industry research.

Where the savings come from.

Four are modeled; the fifth is operation-specific. The answer should be your own figure — not a universal promise.

- 01

Freight and rerouting avoided

\$281,250 — freight already spent, plus the cost of moving the load elsewhere.
- 02

Product value recovered

\$330,000 — load value preserved when internal quality is known before shipping.
- 03

QC labor savings or redeployment

\$38,961 — shift time absorbed by sampling and subjective quality calls.
- 04

Destructively sampled fruit

Operation-specific. Excluded from the \$700,000.
- 05

Claims and chargebacks avoided

\$50,000 — documented claims, net of value counted under 02.

FROM A FEW SAMPLES TO EVERY-FRUIT INFORMATION

Orbem’s Genus Echo inspects internal watermelon quality non-destructively at up to 44,000 lb/hour.

BENCHMARK YOUR OPERATION

BENCHMARK

CONFIDENTIAL REVIEW

amkappes-cmd.github.io/orbem-watermelon

calendar.app.google/1pP3A1nvstA7CGHr8